resources were still inadequate. In those days, the BSF had four patrolling boats to monitor activities over fifty-eight miles of the riverine border in the Sunderbans area. The government decided to shop for more boats and equipment as well as raise four battalions of border wing home guards for effective liaison with the BSF. The MHA said:

It would be necessary for the state level coordination committees presided over by the chief secretaries to periodically review the incidence of influx and steps taken to deal with the problem. Such meetings should be held at least once a month. The state level meetings should be attended by sector inspector general of the BSF and representatives of Intelligence Bureau and R&AW. At the district level, commandant of the BSF battalion deployed in the area and the local representatives of the Intelligence Bureau

and R&AW would be associated with these meetings. It would be necessary for the central agencies and the state police to have quick and regular exchange of intelligence regarding influx from Bangladesh. The existing arrangements for collection and collation of intelligence will have to be reviewed and wherever necessary, strengthened. The influx of refugees may by itself create tensions in the border areas due to various socio-economic reasons. It would be necessary for the state governments and the district authorities to exercise necessary vigilance so that trouble, if any, can be nipped in the bud.

Meanwhile the MEA, which works to establish good diplomatic relationships with the other countries, worried that Indian actions might give the Bangladeshi regime the impression that New Delhi was not happy with it. K.R. Narayanan, additional secretary in the ministry, argued that even though the new